

DailyKhata

Target Market & Audience Analysis

Members: *Saad Mughal- Khadijah Zahoor- Zainab Ali Baig- Aleeza Qaiser*

Supervisor: *Nouman Ali*



Part 1: Problem Identification

1.1 Problem Description

Most people in Pakistan who try to keep track of personal or household spending do not use a dedicated budgeting system at all. Instead, they rely on ad-hoc tools that were never designed for the job: loose sheets of paper, a rough diary, the back of a receipt, or a generic notes app on their phone. Because these tools have no structure, no categories, no totals, no history, the “tracking” that happens is really just scattered jotting. The result is that people frequently lose track of where their money actually went, and a large share give up on tracking altogether, not because they don't want to budget, but because doing it without a proper system is more effort than it's worth.

This sits one level below the digitisation problem covered in the Target Market document (fading paper receipts, manual OCR-style entry): the absence of any consistent system at all is what causes people to fall off tracking in the first place, before automation even becomes relevant.

1.2 Context / Situation

The problem shows up most clearly in everyday, cash-heavy spending- groceries, transport, small vendor purchases. In this context, a person makes several small purchases across a day or week with no single record-keeping habit. Some jot amounts in a diary, some open a phone notes app after the fact (often hours later, from memory), and many simply keep receipts loose with no plan to revisit them. Because these methods are informal and inconsistently maintained, the “budget picture” for the month exists only in fragments, scattered across paper, an app, and memory, or does not exist at all.

1.3 Existing Process / System and Its Limitations

The “existing system” most people use isn't a system in the formal sense- it's a patchwork of manual habits people default to when no proper tool is available:

- Paper / diary tracking: entries are handwritten, unstructured, and easy to skip on busy days; there is no running total and no way to search past entries.
- Generic notes apps (e.g. phone Notes): free-text entry with no categorisation, no calculations, and no separation between one month and the next.
- Memory alone: for a meaningful share of small transactions, nothing is recorded at all; the person simply tries to “remember roughly” what they spent.

The limitation shared by all three is the same one our fieldwork confirmed directly (see 1.5 below): there is no structure enforcing consistency, so upkeep depends entirely on individual discipline on any given day. The moment that discipline lapses- which happens quickly, since each entry takes real effort and

gives no immediate payoff- the record becomes incomplete, and an incomplete budget is often treated as a failed one, which is what drives people to abandon tracking rather than restart it.

1.4 Method Used to Identify the Problem

The team used two methods together: short interviews and informal observation, run over the course of about a week.

Interviews: the team had 10–15 minute in-person and phone conversations with three people representing our target segments- Ayesha Tariq (34, homemaker), Hamza Sheikh (21, university student), and Usman Raza (46, small shopkeeper), asking a consistent set of questions: (1) how do you currently keep track of what you spend, (2) how often do you actually update it, (3) have you ever tried a budgeting app or notebook and stopped, why, and (4) what would make you more likely to keep it up. These same three people were revisited later with additional requirement-focused questions (see Part 3).

Observation: team members watched what happened right after a small cash purchase among family members, roommates, and classmates, in home kitchens, hostel rooms, the university canteen, and a neighbourhood shop, noting whether anything was written down, an app was opened, a receipt was kept, or nothing happened at all. This was done in the moment rather than by asking people to describe their habits afterward, since self-reported habits tend to sound more organised than actual behaviour.

1.5 Evidence / Findings

Observation findings: most purchases were not logged at the time of sale. When spending was logged at all, it was almost always done later, from memory, with amounts sometimes rounded or forgotten entirely. People who used a phone notes app had no way to see totals by category or compare month to month without manually re-reading old entries.

Interview findings:

“If I could just take a picture and it sorts itself out, I would actually keep doing it. Typing it all in is why I stop after two weeks.” — Ayesha Tariq, homemaker

“I deleted the last app I tried because filling in every field felt like an assignment, not something I would do on my own.” — Hamza Sheikh, university student

“Even if I could just say the amount out loud when a customer pays, that alone would stop me from losing track.” — Usman Raza, shopkeeper

Across both methods, the same pattern held: every person interviewed said they wanted visibility into their spending, but the effort required to maintain any of the available methods, typing, filling fields, remembering to log at all, was the reason tracking broke down within days or weeks, not lack of interest in budgeting itself.

1.6 Problem Statement

Laymen typically track their budget, if at all, using loose paper, a rough diary, or a generic notes app, with no structure to keep entries consistent. This leads to incomplete records, lost visibility into where money went, and eventual abandonment, since maintaining any of these methods without a proper system is more effort than most people are willing to sustain.

Part 2: Stakeholder Identification

2.1 Industry

Financial Technology (FinTech), specifically the personal expense management and digital budgeting application category within Pakistan's digital financial services sector.

2.2 Market

DailyKhata operates in the market of personal expense management and digital budgeting applications tailored to Pakistani users. Comparable solutions include international expense trackers such as Mint, Wallet, and Cashew, as well as generic solutions such as Notion-based budget sheets and bank-provided spending summaries. DailyKhata differentiates itself by digitising the traditional “khata” (ledger) practice already familiar to Pakistani households and shopkeepers, using OCR and conversational AI instead of requiring users to adopt a completely new, Western-style budgeting workflow.

2.3 Market Segment

The target segment consists of Pakistani adults, approximately 18 to 50 years old, who manage personal or household budgets and frequently deal with paper receipts and cash-based transactions:

- Homemakers and household budget managers: manage recurring household expenses such as groceries and utilities, often using low-to-mid-range Android phones.
- University students: manage personal spending, allowances, and stipends, and are generally more comfortable with technology.
- Salaried professionals: need to reconcile and understand their monthly personal expenses.
- Small shopkeepers and SMEs: deal with petty cash, supplier receipts, and frequent daily transactions.

Among these, homemakers/household budget managers and university students are the core target groups, as their daily spending behaviour most closely matches the problem DailyKhata is designed to solve.

2.4 User Profile

DailyKhata's target users are Pakistani smartphone users who regularly deal with paper receipts and small cash transactions — grocery purchases, utility payments, transport, rickshaw fares, and local vendor purchases.

Technical knowledge varies: university students are generally more tech-comfortable, while homemakers and household budget managers may have comparatively lower digital confidence and may rely on low-to-mid-range Android smartphones. Existing expense-tracking behaviour is manual and inconsistent, physical receipts, notebooks, phone notes, or memory, all of which require continued manual effort and make it difficult to maintain an accurate spending history.

Users need a system that provides: fast digitisation of receipts, accurate automatic categorisation, historical price tracking, natural-language querying, minimal manual input, quick and responsive results, and secure handling of financial information. Terminology should also be locally familiar — e.g. “Ration” rather than an unfamiliar Western-style category.

2.5 Personas

Persona 1: Ayesha Tariq

Role: Homemaker | Age: 34 | Type: Primary User

Goal: Digitise grocery receipts to track weekly household spending.

- Needs: Fast digitisation of grocery receipts, minimal manual data entry, automatic categorisation, locally relevant categories, historical price tracking, clear visibility into household spending.
- Pain Points: Physical receipts fade or get misplaced; manual entry is time-consuming; existing apps use rigid Western categories; no easy way to compare item prices over time.
- Behaviour: Regularly handles grocery and household purchases; frequently deals with paper receipts and cash; uses a low-to-mid-range Android phone; more likely to adopt a system requiring a simple action (photographing a receipt) over manual entry.
- Expectations: A photographed receipt becomes a structured record within seconds; OCR results accurately match the receipt; items are categorised automatically; minimal manual input; data stored and handled securely.

Persona 2: Bilal Ahmed

Role: Salaried Professional | Age: 27 | Type: Primary User

Goal: Reconcile monthly expenses without manual data entry.

- Needs: Automated expense recording, minimal manual input, clear monthly spending information, natural-language access to spending history, easily searchable records.
- Pain Points: Manual entry and categorisation are time-consuming; existing apps require too much ongoing maintenance; paper receipts have no searchable history; navigating menus/filters/reports creates friction when a quick answer is needed.
- Behaviour: Reviews spending to understand monthly expenses; comfortable with digital tools but benefits from automation; needs quick access to prior spending information.
- Expectations: Minimal manual effort to record expenses; automatic categorisation; plain-language access to spending history; quick system responses; secure data handling.

Persona 3: Hamza Sheikh

Role: University Student | Age: 21 | Type: Primary User

Goal: Track day-to-day personal spending and allowance without it feeling like extra work.

- Needs: Near-instant logging (voice, photo, or a quick tap); no multi-field manual forms; a system that fits around irregular, small, frequent spending rather than formal budgeting sessions.
- Pain Points: Filling in every field on a transaction “felt like an assignment”; abandoned a previous budgeting app within days for this reason; forgets to log smaller purchases (tea, transport) since there's no receipt or reminder.
- Behaviour: Comfortable with technology generally, but low tolerance for manual data entry specifically; spends in small, frequent, often cash-based amounts; more likely to log something if it takes a few seconds than if it requires opening a form.
- Expectations: Logging an expense should take seconds, not fields to fill in; the app should work for cash spending with no receipt at all; categorisation should happen automatically, not manually.

2.6 Other Stakeholders

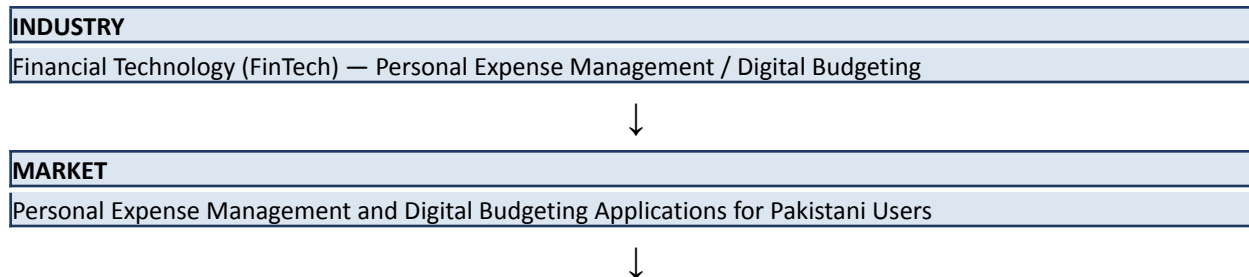
- Zubair Hassan: Family Member, Secondary User. Spouse of a primary user; reviews the shared household budget each month rather than performing the main receipt-digitisation task himself. Needs: clear, trustworthy, understandable household budget summaries.
- Usman Raza: Small Shopkeeper (46), Secondary User. Tracks daily petty-cash and supplier expenses for his general store. Needs: reliable records of petty cash and supplier expenses, clear spending summaries.
- Accountants / Financial Advisors: Secondary Stakeholders. May use reports generated from DailyKhata during periodic financial reviews rather than interacting with the app day-to-day. Needs: clarity, exportability, trustworthy financial summaries.
- DailyKhata Product / Development Team: Internal Stakeholder. Responsible for building, maintaining, and administering the app. Needs: system reliability, maintainability, manageable support burden.
- Data Privacy / Regulatory Context: External Stakeholder. DailyKhata processes receipts and personal spending histories, so privacy and secure handling of financial information must be considered. Needs: secure storage and handling of sensitive financial records.
- Future Bank / Payment API Partners: Future Stakeholder. Banks or payment providers may become stakeholders if DailyKhata introduces automatic transaction importing later. Needs: reliable, standardised API integration. Scope: future work, not part of the current core system.

2.7 Master Stakeholder Table

Category	Stakeholder	Role	Needs	Impact on System
Primary User	Ayesha Tariq (Homemaker, 34)	Digitises grocery receipts to track weekly household spending	Fast digitisation, minimal manual input, accurate OCR, local categories, price history	Drives OCR accuracy, simplicity, local categorisation, and price-history requirements

Primary User	Bilal Ahmed (Salaried Professional, 27)	Reconciles monthly expenses without manual data entry	Automation, minimal upkeep, natural-language queries, clear spending information	Drives automation, conversational querying, and reporting requirements
Primary User	Hamza Sheikh (University Student, 21)	Tracks personal spending and allowance day to day	Near-instant, low-effort logging; no multi-field forms	Drives voice/photo-first logging and auto-categorisation requirements
Secondary User	Zubair Hassan (Family Member)	Reviews the shared household budget	Clear and trustworthy summaries	Drives clarity and shared-budget reporting needs
Secondary User	Usman Raza (Small Shopkeeper, 46)	Tracks petty cash and supplier expenses	Reliable records and clear summaries	Influences petty-cash and small-business use cases
Secondary Stakeholder	Accountants / Financial Advisors	Review financial reports periodically	Clear, exportable, trustworthy reports	Drives report clarity and exportability needs
Internal Stakeholder	DailyKhata Product / Development Team	Builds, maintains, and administers the application	Reliability and maintainability	Drives technical architecture and administrative needs
External Stakeholder	Data Privacy / Regulatory Context	Influences handling of financial information	Secure handling and storage of sensitive data	Drives privacy and security requirements
Future Stakeholder	Bank / Payment API Partners	Potential future transaction integration	Reliable and standardised API integration	Influences future integration requirements (out of current scope)

2.8 Stakeholder Identification Funnel



MARKET SEGMENT

Pakistani adults (≈18–50) who manage personal/household budgets and deal frequently with paper receipts and cash transactions



USER PROFILE

Pakistani smartphone users needing simple, low-effort expense tracking, minimal manual input, familiar local terminology, and support for paper receipts and cash spending



PRIMARY USERS / PERSONAS

Ayesha Tariq (Homemaker) • Bilal Ahmed (Salaried Professional) • Hamza Sheikh (University Student)



SECONDARY USERS

Zubair Hassan (Family Member) • Usman Raza (Shopkeeper) • Accountants / Financial Advisors



OTHER STAKEHOLDERS

DailyKhata Product / Development Team • Data Privacy / Regulatory Context • Future Bank / Payment API Partners

Part 3: Requirement Elicitation

This section covers the techniques used to gather requirements: why each was chosen, who was involved, how it was carried out, what was found, and the requirements drawn from those findings.

Question	Technique 1: Interviews	Technique 2: Existing System Analysis	Technique 3: Observation
Why selected	Gives direct access to real target users (homemakers, students, a shopkeeper); surfaces needs users cannot always describe on their own.	Competitor apps (Cashew, Wallet, bank apps) already reflect assumptions about what users need, so testing them is a fast, low-cost way to find gaps.	Shows actual behaviour rather than what people say they do.
Who was involved	Three people from the target segments, revisited from the Part 1 interviews with three extra requirement-focused questions: Ayesha Tariq (34, homemaker), Hamza Sheikh (21, university student), and Usman Raza (46, small shopkeeper).	Team members who tested the apps.	Family members, roommates, and classmates of the team, observed informally at the moment of a small cash purchase: in home kitchens, hostel rooms, the university canteen, and a neighbourhood shop.
How it was conducted	10–15 minute in-person and phone conversations, carried out right after the Part 1 interviews. Each person was asked three extra questions: (1) if logging an expense took under 10 seconds, would you actually do it every time, (2) would you rather type, speak, or photograph a receipt, (3) what would make you trust an auto-categorised entry enough not to double-check it.	Each team member spent 30–45 minutes testing Cashew, Wallet, and a bank app's spending-summary feature on an Android device — adding a grocery-style expense, then checking whether the app kept a price history for repeated items.	Team members watched what happened right after a purchase (written down, app opened, receipt kept, or nothing), rather than asking people to describe their habits afterward, since people tend to describe their habits as more organised than they really are.
Findings	Photographing a receipt or speaking beat typing every time — typing was the exact reason a couple of people gave for dropping tracking apps before. People still wanted to check an auto-categorised entry before it saved; one wrong category would be enough to lose their trust in the rest of the app. No-receipt cash spending (rickshaw fares,	All three apps required typing every field (vendor, amount, category), with no camera or voice option. Cashew and Wallet used Western default categories (Groceries, Dining) with no easy way to rename them to local terms. None of the three showed a price-history view for a repeated item across purchases. The bank app's spending summary	Most purchases were not logged at the time of sale. When logged at all, it happened later from memory, with amounts sometimes rounded or forgotten. Several people who used a phone notes app had no way to see category totals or compare month to month without manually re-reading old entries.

	roadside vendors) kept coming up as the type of spending most likely to never get logged, since there is nothing to photograph.	only showed totals by generic merchant type, not itemised data.	
→ Requirements derived	• Log a cash expense by voice/short text in under 10 seconds • Show AI-categorised entries for user confirmation before saving • Support logging a no-receipt cash transaction via voice or a quick tap • Support after-the-fact entry with minimal effort	• Auto-categorise line items without manual tagging • Keep and display item-level price history across repeated purchases • Allow category labels to be renamed to local terms without losing the underlying account mapping	• Support after-the-fact entry with minimal effort (spending often logged late, if at all) • Show at-a-glance category totals without requiring manual review of past entries

3.1 Consolidated Requirements List

All requirements from the table above are combined below, split by type.

Functional Requirements

- The system shall pull structured data (items, prices, totals) from a photographed receipt using OCR.
- The system shall accept cash or no-receipt transactions through text or voice input.
- The system shall automatically sort line items into locally relevant categories (e.g. “Ration”).
- The system shall let users ask about their spending history in plain language (e.g. “how much did I spend on groceries this month”).
- The system shall track and show price history for repeated items over time.
- The system shall show AI-categorised entries for the user to confirm before saving, rather than saving them automatically.
- The system shall allow local category labels (e.g. “Ration”) to be used instead of accounting-style codes, without losing the underlying account mapping.
- The system shall support adding an expense entry after the fact, not only at the time of purchase, with minimal effort.
- The system shall display category-level spending totals at a glance, without requiring users to manually review past entries.

Non-Functional Requirements

- OCR extraction shall finish within a few seconds of a receipt photo being submitted.
- User financial data shall be stored and sent securely.
- The interface shall need minimal typing and navigation, given the lower digital literacy of part of the user base.

- The app shall remain usable on a low-to-mid-range Android device with an inconsistent data connection, matching the target users' typical hardware.
- Logging a single expense, by voice, photo, or quick tap, shall take under 10 seconds from start to finish, since willingness to log drops sharply beyond that.